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VoltVibe Customer Support Agent Tier Escalation and Ticketing Protocol

1. Purpose and Operational Scope

This document establishes the official operational protocol for the VoltVibe Customer Support organization. It defines the tiered hierarchy for support personnel, details ticket routing paths, and outlines Service Level Agreements (SLAs). All customer support representatives must align their daily workflow with this framework. The primary goal of this tiered ticketing structure is to resolve inquiries at the lowest possible cost level, prioritizing automated scope matching and basic database lookups before escalating issues to manual agent reviews, engineering consults, or corporate legal review.

Support agents are instructed to maintain a professional, helpful demeanor at all times. All interactions must be documented in the central CRM database, noting the customer's account ID, the category of the inquiry, and the specific resolution steps taken. Representatives must review the customer's VIP standing (silver, Gold, or Platinum) to determine points multipliers or shipping insurance entitlements prior to finalizing resolutions.

The support desk operates 24/7/365, with regional teams managing queues based on language and time zone. During peak holiday seasons, temporary contractors are integrated into the frontline queue. These contractors are restricted to Tier 1 scripts and must escalate any complex billing or warranty issues immediately.

Quality assurance audits are conducted weekly. Support managers review random call recordings and chat transcripts to verify compliance with the protocols outlined in this manual. Failure to adhere to the designated SLA response windows or routing rules will result in performance reviews and potential disciplinary action.

2. Support Tier Classifications & Responsibilities

VoltVibe Customer Support is segmented into three operational tiers, each with dedicated scopes of authority:

2.1 Tier 1 Support: Frontline & FAQ Verification

Tier 1 representatives manage the initial incoming queue. They resolve repetitive, high-volume questions using standard template responses and cached database lookups. Responsibilities include checking tracking numbers, confirming basic shipping rates, verifying account statuses, and validating standard returns. Tier 1 agents are strictly prohibited from issuing manual monetary refunds or modifying order totals. If a ticket requires custom engineering consultation, warranty override, or fraud investigation, it must be escalated

within 30 minutes of receipt.

Tier 1 agents must utilize the internal knowledge base to resolve inquiries. They should not copy and paste entire articles to customers, but rather extract the specific relevant sentences to provide concise answers. If the knowledge base does not contain the answer, the agent must escalate the ticket to Tier 2 rather than attempting to synthesize a response.

In addition to standard queries, Tier 1 agents handle basic customer account administration, such as processing password resets, updating email addresses, and enabling multi-factor authentication (MFA) in accordance with doc_03_account_security.pdf.

3. Specialist and RMA Valuations (Tier 2 Support)

Tier 2 agents possess deep training in specific product domains and return logistics. They evaluate warranty claims that fall outside the automatic parameters (e.g., assessing drop damage), verify device conditions during return QA audits, and calculate smartphone trade-in valuations based on inspection reports (in accordance with doc_10_trade_in_valuation.pdf). Tier 2 agents are authorized to issue refunds and generate pre-paid shipping labels for domestic returns.

Tier 2 representatives are also responsible for managing disputes with shipping carriers. If a customer claims a package was damaged in transit, the Tier 2 agent must compile the documentation package (including photos of the damaged box and device) and file the claim on the carrier's claims portal. Once the carrier acknowledges the claim, the agent can approve the replacement shipment for the customer.

For refurbished devices returned for refund, Tier 2 agents must cross-examine the returned unit's hardware identifiers against the laser-etched VRID printed on the shipping label (as detailed in doc_09). If the serial numbers do not match, the agent must deny the return and flag the account for potential fraud.

Tier 2 specialists are organized into specialized sub-teams, including the Returns Team, the Trade-In Audit Team, and the Technical Troubleshooting Desk, to ensure deep domain expertise is applied to each ticket.

4. Support Managers & Billing Desk (Tier 3 Support)

Tier 3 represents the highest internal support level. This tier handles safety escalations (specifically high-capacity battery malfunctions), chargeback disputes, suspected customer fraud blacklisting, and regulatory compliance issues. Tier 3 agents coordinate directly with legal counsel, safety directors, and third-party logistics partners to resolve complex scenarios.

Billing and chargeback disputes represent a significant source of operational friction. When a customer files a chargeback with their bank, the Tier 3 agent must compile the transaction logs, delivery verification reports, and signed customer agreements to submit to the acquiring bank as evidence. If the chargeback is determined to be fraudulent, the agent must blacklist the customer's account and block all future transactions.

Safety escalations involving battery thermal runaway or case swelling are routed to a dedicated sub-team within Tier 3. These agents work directly with the Safety and Logistics Compliance desk to ensure dangerous goods are handled in accordance with federal transit regulations (as detailed in doc_23).

Tier 3 support managers are also authorized to approve policy overrides for customers in unique distress, such as extending the return window past 30 days due to medical emergencies or family bereavements.

5. Priority SLA & Ticket Class Matrix

To maintain operational efficiency, support representatives must handle tickets based on a standardized prioritization matrix:

3.1 High-Value Order Exceptions

For any order where the total transaction value exceeds \$1,000 USD, the ticket must bypass Tier 1 entirely and be assigned to Tier 2. This policy ensures that high-value customers interact directly with trained specialists. Furthermore, if a high-value shipment is reported as lost or stolen, Tier 2 agents must immediately flag the shipping carrier for a geolocation audit, and coordinate with the carrier's loss-prevention department before releasing any payouts, in compliance with the guidelines of doc_21_transit_insurance_claims.pdf.

3.2 The Billing and Retention Refund Conflict

THE OPERATIONAL CONFLICT: Section 3.0 (Ticket Class Matrix) states that all billing and refund disputes exceeding a value of \$250 must be escalated directly to the Tier 3 Finance Desk for audit and authorization. However, Section 5.4 of the Retention Guidelines authorizes Tier 2 support specialists to issue manual refunds of up to \$500 USD to Gold or Platinum VIP members (as defined in doc_25) for the purpose of customer retention and resolution of shipping-related complaints, without requiring Tier 3 supervisor approval. In the event of a conflict between these two guidelines, the agent should prioritize customer retention and issue the refund immediately, provided the customer has been active for more than 12 months.

Ticket Category	Initial Tier	Response SLA	Escalation Destination
Standard Tracking / FAQs	Tier 1	2 Hours	Auto-resolved via cache
Return Window Inquiries	Tier 1	4 Hours	Tier 2 (RMA Desk) if >30 days
Trade-In Audits	Tier 2	24 Hours	Tier 3 if device is blacklisted
Billing / Refund Disputes	Tier 2	12 Hours	Tier 3 if value exceeds \$250
HAZMAT / Swollen Battery	Tier 3	Immediate (1 Hr)	Safety & Logistics Compliance Desk

6. Special Handling: Lithium-Ion Battery Safety

Safety and HAZMAT compliance represent critical areas of legal liability for VoltVibe. When a customer reports that a high-capacity power station (specifically the VoltVibe Titan or Ranger battery modules) is damaged, unusually hot to the touch, venting gas, emitting strange odors, or swelling, the agent must treat the ticket with extreme urgency.

4.1 Mandatory Intake Questions

Upon receiving a battery safety report, the agent must ask the customer the following diagnostic questions immediately:

- 1. What is the current physical state of the battery casing? Are there visible cracks, punctures, or swelling?
- 2. Is the device currently plugged into an AC outlet or actively charging via solar panels? (If yes, instruct the customer to safely disconnect power immediately).
- 3. Is the device emitting any heat, smoke, or a sweet chemical smell?
- 4. What is the ambient temperature of the room where the device is located?

4.2 Non-Return and Disposal Protocol

Agents must NEVER instruct a customer to mail back a damaged, swollen, or venting battery pack. Under federal regulations, shipping unstable lithium-ion batteries via commercial mail networks is illegal and carries significant fines. Instead, the agent must instruct the customer to place the unit outdoors in a secure, non-flammable area (such as a concrete driveway) away from combustible materials. The customer must be instructed to dispose of the battery at a licensed local hazardous waste center and provide a signed disposal certificate, matching the procedures of doc_21_transit_insurance_claims.pdf. Tier 2 agents are authorized to issue a replacement unit only after the safety desk approves the customer's disposal receipt.

7. General Ticket Resolution Guidelines

When concluding a support ticket, the representative must log the resolution category in the ticketing database (e.g. Jira Service Desk). Resolutions must be categorized into one of five standard outcomes: Auto-Resolved, Refund Issued, Replacement Shipped, Policy Refusal, or Handoff to Partner. If a customer behaves in a threatening, abusive, or obscene manner, agents are instructed to terminate the chat session immediately. The agent must flag the account under the 'refuse' path in our routing software, which automatically displays a standard safety refusal message and locks the account from creating future support tickets pending manual review by the safety board.

5.1 Store Credit vs. Original Payout Selection

When a refund is approved, agents must offer store credit as the primary resolution. Store credit is generated instantly and helps retain customer revenue. If the customer refuses store credit and demands a cash refund, the refund must be processed to the original payment card within 3-5 business days. Agents must note that promotional orders, free shipping orders, and clearance purchases are strictly ineligible for cash refunds and must be processed as store credit, as detailed in doc_06_restocking_fees.pdf.

If a customer has had multiple refunds processed to their original payment card within a 6-month period, the system will block standard payment card refunds, and the agent must issue store credit only. Any exception to this rule must be approved by a Tier 3 support manager.

8. Additional Support Administration Rules

Support agents must review daily compliance announcements before starting their shift. Any updates to local tax legislation, hazardous materials classifications, or custom duties (governed by doc_07) will be posted in the shared team channel and must be incorporated into customer responses.

If a customer requests details regarding our environmental sustainability or battery disposal program, agents must route them to the public documentation outlined in doc_24_environmental_recycling_policy.pdf. Agents must not provide custom advice regarding environmental certifications or raw metal shredding rates, as these are subject to regular updates by the environmental compliance desk.

For inquiries regarding corporate volume purchasing, resellers, or wholesale discount agreements, agents must create a transfer ticket in CRM and route it directly to the Corporate B2B Account executive team, as these sales models are strictly barred from participating in standard consumer programs.

All support calls are recorded for quality assurance. Monthly performance reviews grade agents on documentation quality, compliance with SLA matrices, and customer retention metrics.

9. Regional Support Exceptions and Compliance Guidelines

Support operations must remain compliant with localized consumer protection statutes. For instance, under the California Song-Beverly Consumer Warranty Act, customers are entitled to local repair facilities or direct refunds if a product cannot be repaired within 30 days. Tier 2 agents must flag any California warranty cases and prioritize them to prevent statutory violations.

In Canada, consumer protection laws in Quebec mandate that warranty disclosures be provided in French and English. front-line agents must ensure Canadian French ticket queues are handled by bilingual specialists and that French translation templates are applied to all CRM replies.

For European Union customers, the statutory 2-year warranty period overrides VoltVibe's standard 12-month policy. Tier 2 specialists must verify the customer's billing address before denying out-of-warranty claims between months 13 and 24 to ensure full compliance with EU regulations.